

Organize, Develop & Revise

Study Guide - Extended Response

1. Learning goal

Turn good analysis into a clear response with purposeful paragraphs, developed reasoning, precise revision, and readable Standard English.

2. What this skill means

Organization makes your reasoning easy to follow. Development makes each reason complete. Revision removes vague, repetitive, or source-drifting language. Editing fixes sentence-level problems that interfere with clarity.

3. Do not confuse it with

A five-paragraph template is not the goal by itself. A shorter response with clear thesis, developed body reasoning, and controlled language can be stronger than a longer response full of repetition.

4. How GED-style questions may ask it

Practice may ask you to order paragraph parts, choose a stronger revision, improve a transition, or edit grammar and punctuation in an analytical sentence.

5. Repeatable method

- Use a short introduction: issue → stronger source → main reasons.
- Give each body paragraph one main reason.
- Use Point → Evidence → Analysis → Comparison.
- Revise vague words such as good/bad/stronger when you can name the actual evidence problem.
- Edit sentence boundaries, agreement, punctuation, and source qualifiers.

6. Worked example

Source B is bad and does not make sense.

Question: How should this be revised?

Reasoning: The sentence is vague. A better revision names the missing comparison or unsupported prediction.

Best answer: Source B raises a cost concern but provides no estimate showing that the cost outweighs the measured benefit.

7. Common traps

- Writing a long hook instead of the thesis.
- Putting several unrelated reasons in one paragraph.
- Repeating stronger/better without explaining why.
- Editing for fancy vocabulary instead of clarity.

8. Diagnostic help

- If a paragraph feels scattered, underline its one main point; move or cut sentences that do not serve it.
- If your conclusion introduces new evidence, move that evidence into the body.
- If grammar mistakes make your meaning hard to follow, prioritize sentence boundaries and agreement before minor style changes.

9. Quick check

Source A is stronger and better and more supported because its evidence is stronger.

Revise for precision.

Check yourself: Source A is better supported because its pilot data measures the policy's actual outcome.